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JTA planning additional layoffs as it works to cut \$39 million from FY 2027 budget, suspend Skyway service in November

Along with additional administrative layoffs, JTA could eliminate as many as 150 frontline operations positions.

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JACKSONVILLE, Fla. – The [Jacksonville Transportation Authority](#) will reduce its Fiscal Year 2027 budget by \$39 million, suspend passenger service on the Skyway and pause Navi service as it works to balance revenue and expenses, Interim CEO Cleveland Ferguson said.

The JTA's board approved a \$139 million budget for the fiscal year beginning Oct. 1, down from \$178 million in the current fiscal year. The reductions include \$24.9 million in savings from contractual services, the release of 44 additional administrative employees and potential cuts affecting as many as 150 frontline operations employees.

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The staffing impacts follow layoffs that began in December and another round that began in February, as well as administrative furloughs involving 87 senior employees, Ferguson said.

“My focus is threefold,” Ferguson said. “I’m making the tough decisions now. We’re making the necessary actions to reduce costs and strengthen our financial position.”

The JTA plans to suspend passenger operations on the Skyway beginning Nov. 2, resulting in estimated savings of about \$10 million during the fiscal year while the agency and community determine the system’s future.

Navi service will be paused Jan. 1, 2027. Ferguson said the autonomous vehicles will revert to manual operation because software used by the private-sector provider is set to expire. The change is expected to save about \$487,000 per month.

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Core bus service changes also begin Nov. 2. Weekday service will transition to a Saturday schedule, while preserving frequency on routes with the highest ridership.

First Coast Flyer bus rapid transit lines will continue running every 20 minutes on weekdays. Routes 1, 3, 8, 10 and 19 will operate every 30 minutes during the week. The remaining 12 routes will continue at their current 60-minute service levels.

Riders like Earl Hodges said they aren't happy with the changes.

"I hope they come up with something better than what they're doing, and it gets a little progress with the customer because the customer is not very satisfied with that," Hodges said.

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Ferguson said the JTA is prioritizing essential services while reducing costs.

"We are prioritizing the essential services our community depends on while being most responsible stewards of taxpayers' dollars," he said.

He described the agency's third priority as "stabilizing today to restore tomorrow."

"The faster we get back on strong financial footing, the sooner we can reinstate the service level our community needs and expects," Ferguson said.

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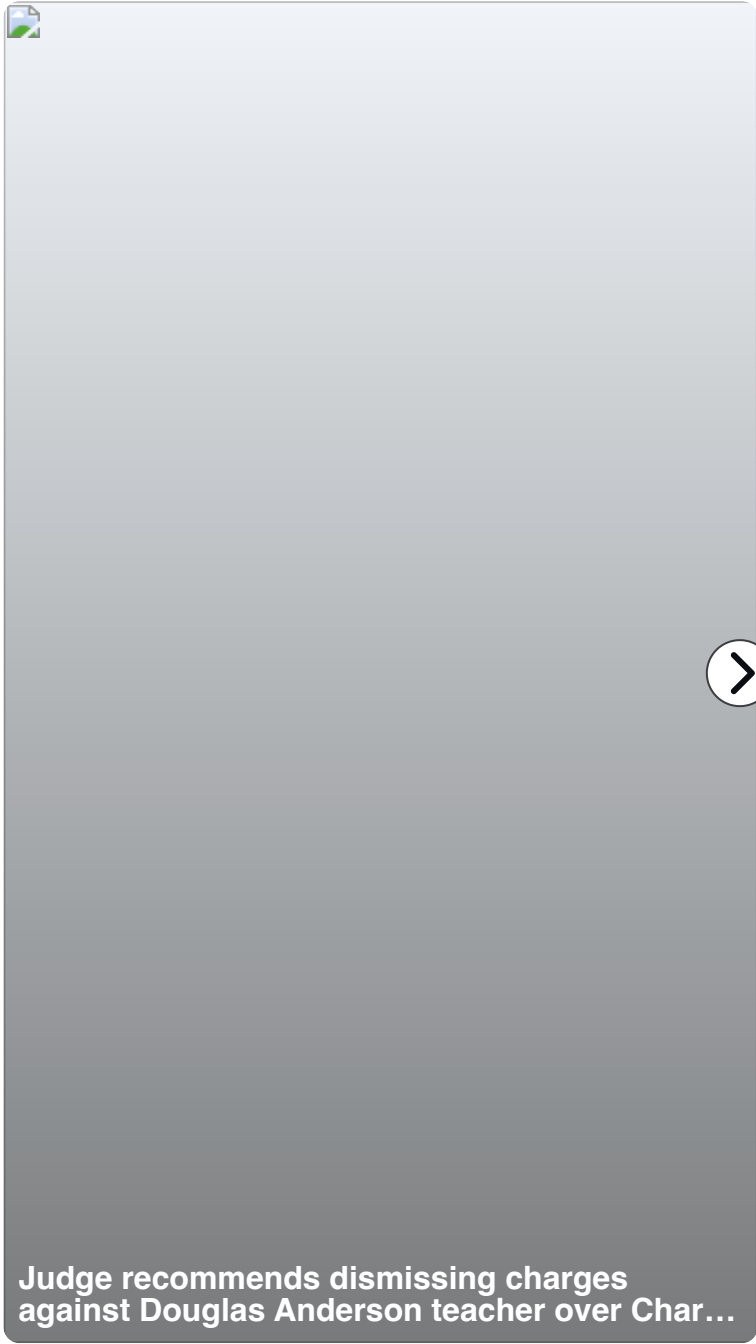
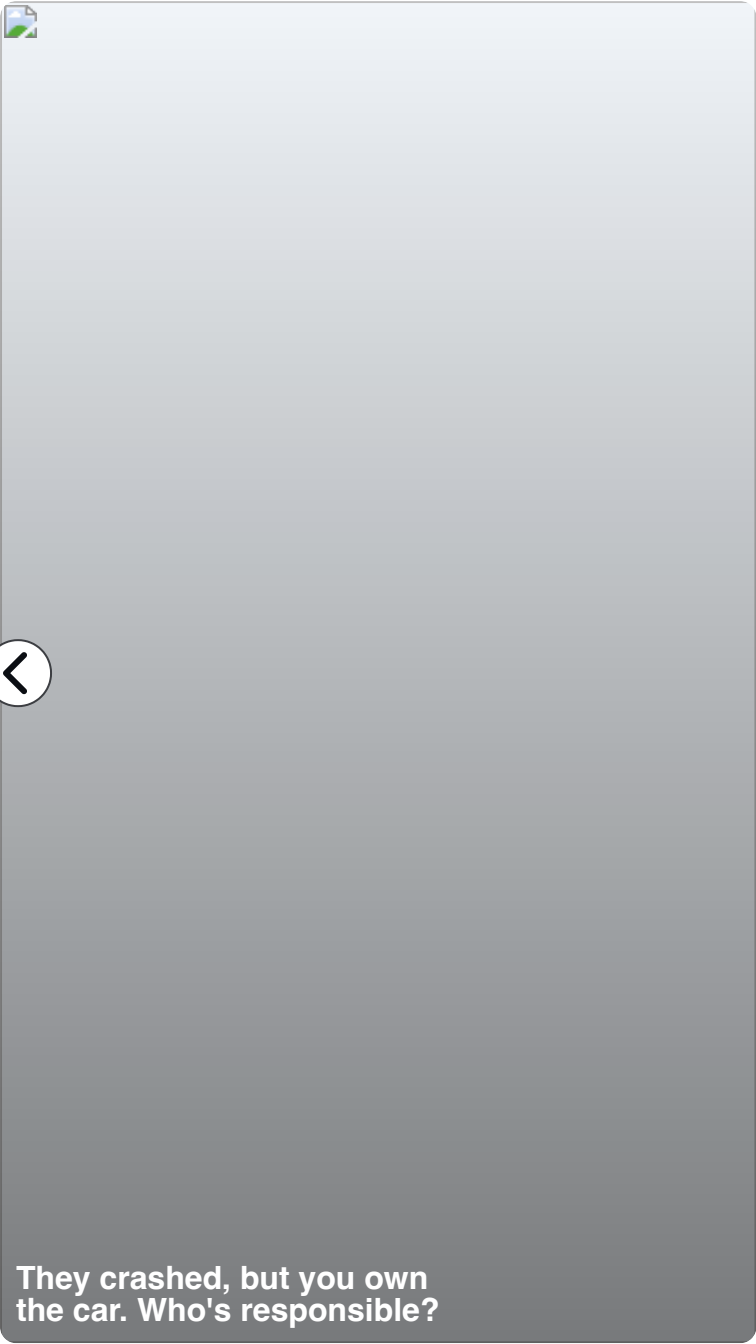
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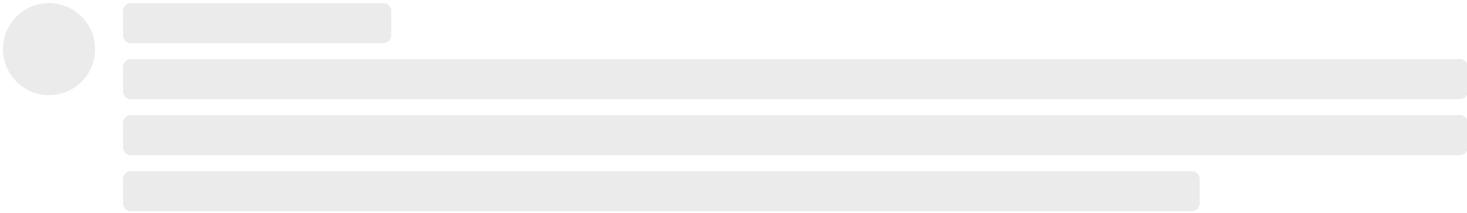
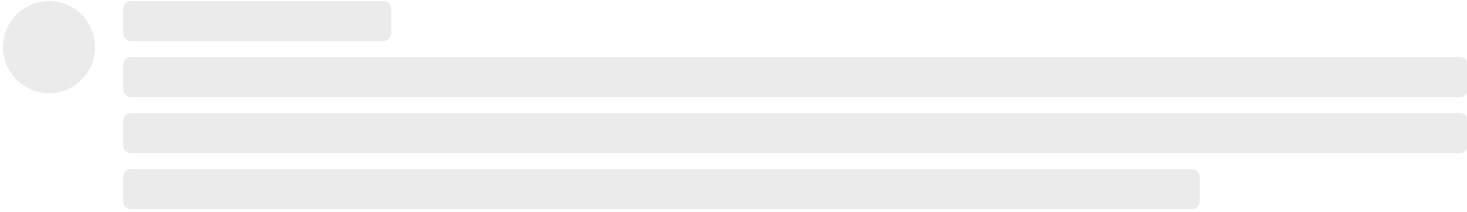
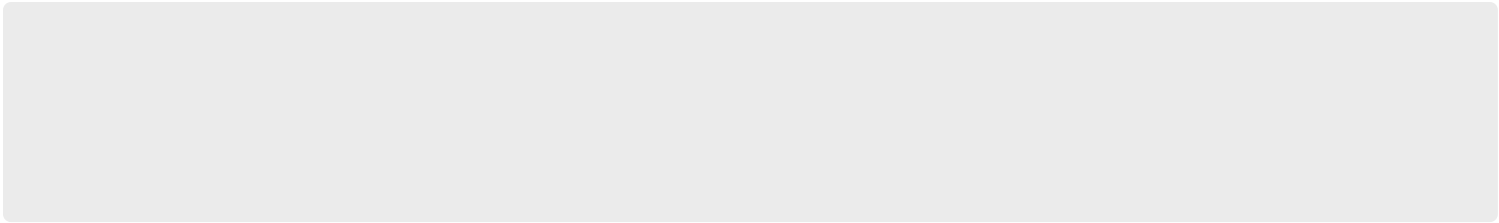
Tommy Garcia's been with News4Jax since April 2004. Since then, he has been a dedicated member of the Photojournalist team. The aspect of the job Tommy enjoys the most is being of service to the community he calls home.



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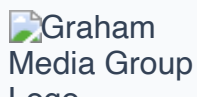


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